

BELLOWS CHAMBER — DM REFERENCE

Hard · ~2,100 adjusted XP for 8 lvl-3 PCs · target 3 rounds

WAVES

- 1 on entry 6 stirges hanging from the overhead ducts
- 2 a bellows worked swarm FLUSHED out of that duct's stub (SW1/SW2)
- 3 other bellows second swarm, other stub – they see it coming

ENEMIES

Stirge x6 (CR 1/8): AC 13, HP 5, fly 40. +5, 1d6+3 pierce + ATTACH (2d4 necrotic at start of its turn; action within 5 ft to detach).
Swarm of Stirges x2 (CR 2): AC 14, HP 36, fly 40. +5, 2d10+3 pierce (1d10+3 when bloodied). RESISTS B/P/S. Occupies creatures' space: Medium- targets in swarm grappled (esc DC 13), 2d6 necrotic at end of their turn. Immune: charm/fright/grapple/prone/restrain/stun.

ROOM & NOTES

Light-hatched squares = junk = DIFFICULT TERRAIN. Bench and crates can be clambered over (also difficult). Bellows: impassable, climbable, half cover behind.
STUBS: both service stubs are UNCAPPED (Perception DC 15, or spot the fallen caps on the floor beside each). The stirges moved into the ducts through them; the swarms nest in the pipes (~1.5 ft bore).
Working a bellows = an action; blasts its duct, flushing its swarm.
RESTORE THE AIR: work both bellows + re-cap BOTH stubs -> enables the cuckoo's call in Act III (bellows are lungs, cuckoo the mouth).
GEAR: wedged behind the east bellows (F12) – visible once cleared.
Journal on the workbench (page visible, A5) = entry-3, The Disconnection. Modron crate (A8) matches the delivery manifest.
Exit up: ladder at C6 beside the main riser. Individuals die in one hit; swarms halve martial damage – AoE and magic shine.
Too easy: survivors re-emerge. Too hard: swarm at half HP flees.

